# Root Cause Analysis (5 Whys) Template · Advanced version

A root cause analysis template guides you from a problem to its underlying cause using the 5 whys, then to corrective actions with owners, so the problem does not come back.

## 5 whys · Keep asking why until you reach a cause you can fix

| Step | Question | Answer |
|---|---|---|
| Problem | What happened, where, when and how much? | Release 2.3 was delayed by 9 days |
| Why 1 | Why did it happen? | Testing started late |
| Why 2 | Why? | The test environment was not ready |
| Why 3 | Why? | Environment requests were raised two days before testing |
| Why 4 | Why? | Environment needs are not part of sprint planning |
| Why 5 | Why? | There is no checklist for release prerequisites |
| Root cause | Summarise the root cause | No release prerequisites checklist in planning |

## Corrective actions · Fix the root cause, not just the symptom

| Action | Type | Owner | Due date | How we will verify it worked | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Add environment readiness to sprint planning checklist | Prevent | Scrum Master | 20 Mar 2026 | Next 3 releases start testing on time | Not started |
| Book environments at release planning | Prevent | Ops lead | 27 Mar 2026 | Bookings logged 2 weeks ahead | Not started |
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